



Business Laptops

The world of business laptops is a slow-moving one, and for good reason. Compared to hustle and bustle of consumer notebooks – which is a constantly churning space with the latest and greatest products thrown at the wall by brands, hoping that at least some of them stick with consumers and get sold off the shelf – business laptops as a category is aimed at slightly more discerning buyers who know what they want. Unlike mainstream consumers like you and me, businesses seldom update their IT hardware on an annual basis – if a business laptop is bought for office use, it won't be replaced for a good 3 to 5 years, easily.

This year, most business laptops from all the major brands have received the latest 4th generation Intel Core chipset update. While the lines between consumer and business laptops are blurring fast – especially in the ultrabook range – brands are still trying hard to preserve the essence of a business laptop, focusing on security, reliability, performance and build quality. With improved onboard Intel graphics on business laptops launched this year, getting our hands on business laptops with discrete GPUs was quite a task! Something to do with “all work and no play” when it comes to office policies, we think. To wrap up, this was another unimpressive year as far as business laptops are concerned, but we've managed to review and compare most of the machines launched in the market. Next year promises to be much the same. Or maybe not. Fingers crossed.

Zero1 Winner

Dell Vostro 14 3446

This is the only business laptop we reviewed all year that we can call positively call as colourful, simply



Acer Travelmate PM645

Price: ₹67,412



Lenovo ThinkPad S1 Yoga

Price: ₹1,12,418

because it comes with a maroon screen lid. The Vostro 14 is nicely built, with a chunky exterior, and a textured plastic screen lid that's different from most conventional business laptops. Apart from the omission of a TPM chip – to encrypt data at the hardware level – every other performance metric on the Dell Vostro 14 was stellar. The Vostro manages to beat everyone else (including laptops that are priced more than 2.5 times higher) in terms of pure brute performance. This is made possible thanks to a large part because of the bundled discrete GPU it has – NVIDIA GeForce 820M. The Dell Vostro laptop also comes with MaxxAudio for better-than-average audio, anti-glare screen for better viewing experience. With 3 hours of battery backup on a single charge, it's a laptop that strikes a great balance between brute-force, number crunching performance and battery performance – something you don't say about every laptop out there.

Worthy mentions

Acer Travelmate PM645

The PM645 is understated in its design. It offers a perfectly adequate CPU and a healthy, 8GB of RAM. The device is powered by an Intel Core i5-4200U, which is standard in this segment, but Acer's thermal management works very well, allowing the CPU to give its full potential, taking this laptop far ahead in our CPU performance benchmarks, outperforming most competing devices. At the same time, the battery life is quite good, with the device clocking in at a little over 4 hours in our tests, which is the best among business laptops we tested this year. You can easily expect close to 6 hours of usage or more if you're just browsing or typing all the time, not consuming multimedia. We liked the battery life, loved the keyboard and were very impressed by the temperature management on this business laptop.

Lenovo ThinkPad S1 Yoga

The only tablet-laptop hybrid worth of consideration by business users, the Lenovo ThinkPad S1 Yoga also provides good overall performance. It has a low-voltage CPU which can multitask with 4-5 apps at once, but can't really set the stage on fire. It has better-than-average screen brightness, contrast ratio. The in-built speakers are good for personal entertainment, as they're both loud and largely distortion-free at high volume. But most importantly, the ThinkPad S1 Yoga's battery life is among the best we've pegged in a business laptop, lasting over 200 minutes in our tests. The ThinkPad S1 Yoga is a very good attempt to mould an iconic laptop into a functional tablet, one that comes with our full recommendation. 



◀ DELL VOSTRO 14 3446

Price: ₹47,000